

# Workflow Automation in FlowDesk

Configure event-driven rules that assign tickets, update priorities, apply tags, send emails, and notify external systems.

## Introduction

FlowDesk Automation helps support teams streamline repetitive work by triggering predefined actions when ticket events occur. Instead of requiring agents to perform the same operational steps manually, administrators and team leads can define automation rules that evaluate an event and its matching criteria, then execute one or more supported actions.

Automation is useful for routing incoming work, standardizing ticket priorities, applying customer or workflow tags, sending operational emails, and notifying external systems through webhooks.

[IMAGE: FlowDesk Automation overview showing triggers, conditions, and actions in a workflow builder]

## Automation Concepts

A FlowDesk automation rule consists of three main parts:

- Trigger** — the event that starts evaluation of the rule.
- Conditions** — matching criteria that determine whether the rule should continue.
- Actions** — the operations FlowDesk performs when the rule matches.

A rule should be designed around a specific operational outcome. For example, a team lead can use a `ticket.created` trigger with matching criteria to identify a class of incoming tickets and then use `assign_ticket` and `add_tag` to standardize initial handling.

## Supported Triggers

FlowDesk supports the following automation triggers:

| Trigger                              | When it runs                        | Typical use                                                 |
|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>ticket.created</code>          | When a new ticket is created.       | Initial routing, tagging, prioritization, or notifications. |
| <code>ticket.updated</code>          | When an existing ticket is updated. | Responding to changes that match configured criteria.       |
| <code>ticket.priority_changed</code> | When a ticket's priority changes.   | Applying follow-up actions when priority changes.           |

[IMAGE: Automation trigger selector displaying `ticket.created`, `ticket.updated`, and `ticket.priority_changed`]

## Supported Actions

When a trigger matches its configured criteria, an automation can execute these supported actions:

| Action                       | Purpose                         |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <code>assign_ticket</code>   | Assigns the ticket to an agent. |
| <code>change_priority</code> | Changes the ticket priority.    |

| Action       | Purpose                                            |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| add_tag      | Adds a tag to the ticket.                          |
| send_email   | Sends an email as part of the automation workflow. |
| send_webhook | Sends a webhook notification.                      |

## Trigger-to-Action Reference

| Trigger                 | Available actions                                                 |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ticket.created          | assign_ticket, change_priority, add_tag, send_email, send_webhook |
| ticket.updated          | assign_ticket, change_priority, add_tag, send_email, send_webhook |
| ticket.priority_changed | assign_ticket, change_priority, add_tag, send_email, send_webhook |

The table describes the supported automation model. A particular rule may use only the actions configured for that rule and any values required by the selected action.

## Create an Automation Rule

Follow these steps to create a new automation rule from scratch.

- 1. Open Automation** — Sign in to FlowDesk and open the Automation area for your workspace.
- 2. Create a rule** — Select the option to create a new automation rule. Enter a clear rule name that describes its purpose.
- 3. Select a trigger** — Choose one supported trigger: `ticket.created`, `ticket.updated`, or `ticket.priority_changed`.
- 4. Configure matching criteria** — Add the conditions that identify the tickets or changes the rule should process. Keep criteria specific enough to prevent unintended matches.
- 5. Add actions** — Select one or more supported actions: `assign_ticket`, `change_priority`, `add_tag`, `send_email`, or `send_webhook`. Configure the required values for each selected action.
- 6. Review the rule** — Check the trigger, conditions, and actions together. Confirm that the rule will not duplicate or conflict with another active automation.
- 7. Save and activate** — Save the rule and activate it when the configuration has been reviewed and tested.

[IMAGE: New automation rule form showing trigger, condition, action, and activation controls]

## Configure Conditional Logic and Matching Criteria

Conditions narrow the set of events that can execute a rule. Use matching criteria to ensure that an automation applies only to the intended tickets or changes.

When configuring conditions:

- Start with the smallest set of criteria that clearly identifies the intended workflow.
- Use criteria that correspond to the ticket information or event change being evaluated.
- For `ticket.updated`, make the rule specific enough to avoid repeatedly matching unrelated updates.
- For `ticket.priority_changed`, define the priority-related criteria needed by the workflow before adding downstream actions.

- Review overlapping rules to determine whether the same ticket could satisfy multiple automations.

**Example:** A team can configure `ticket.created` with criteria that identify a particular category of incoming work, then add `assign_ticket` and `add_tag` so matching tickets are routed and labeled consistently.

[IMAGE: Conditional logic builder with matching criteria applied to an automation trigger]

## Best Practices for Testing and Managing Automations

Use the following practices before relying on an automation in production:

- **Test narrowly.** Start with criteria that match a small, predictable set of tickets.
- **Verify every action.** Confirm that assignments, priority changes, tags, emails, and webhook notifications produce the intended result.
- **Check for overlapping rules.** Two active rules can respond to the same event. Review active automations before creating another rule with similar criteria.
- **Use descriptive names.** Name rules by trigger and business purpose so administrators can identify them quickly.
- **Document dependencies.** If a workflow relies on an external webhook receiver, verify that the receiving system is configured and reachable over HTTPS.
- **Deactivate obsolete rules.** Turn off automations that are no longer required instead of leaving them active with outdated criteria.

### Warning

Avoid creating multiple broad rules for the same trigger and ticket population. Overlapping automations can cause multiple actions to execute on the same event, making the resulting workflow difficult to predict or troubleshoot.

[IMAGE: Automation management list showing active and inactive rules and overlapping-rule review]

## Plan Availability and Limitations

FlowDesk Automation is part of the platform's core workflow capabilities. The Master Product Specification does not define a separate plan-specific automation limit. Automation configuration should therefore follow the capabilities available in the workspace and the plan's other applicable feature restrictions.

Plan-specific restrictions apply to related platform capabilities. For example, API access and webhooks are unavailable on Free, while Pro and Enterprise include API access and webhooks. Advanced analytics are available on Pro and Enterprise, and SSO is available only on Enterprise.

| Plan       | Automation-related notes                                                                                                |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Free       | Automation is available. API access and webhooks are not available on this plan.                                        |
| Pro        | Automation is available. API access and webhooks are available, subject to the plan's 60 requests-per-minute API limit. |
| Enterprise | Automation is available. API access and webhooks are available, with a 300 requests-per-minute API limit.               |

Note: A `send_webhook` action requires webhook capability. Because webhooks are unavailable on Free, Free workspaces cannot use `send_webhook` as an available integration capability.

## Troubleshooting Automation Execution Errors

### ***Rule does not run***

Confirm that the rule is active, the selected trigger matches the event, and the event satisfies every configured condition. Check for overly restrictive criteria.

### ***Unexpected tickets are affected***

Review the rule's matching criteria and broadened conditions. Check other active automations for overlapping rules that may also be processing the same tickets.

### ***Ticket is assigned incorrectly***

Verify the assign\_ticket configuration and review other active rules that can assign tickets. Test the rule with a narrowly defined ticket population.

### ***Priority changes unexpectedly***

Review all active rules using change\_priority, especially rules triggered by ticket.updated or ticket.priority\_changed. Check whether multiple rules match the same event.

### ***Email action does not produce the expected result***

Verify the send\_email configuration and confirm that the rule's conditions match the intended event. If another rule also sends an email, review both rules for overlap.

### ***Webhook action fails***

Confirm that the workspace has webhook capability, the receiving endpoint accepts HTTPS POST requests, and the endpoint is available. FlowDesk retries failed webhook deliveries up to 3 times.

### ***Rule appears to execute repeatedly***

Review ticket.updated rules for broad criteria. An update produced by one workflow can be relevant to another rule, so narrow conditions and review overlapping active automations.

### ***Webhook Delivery Note***

FlowDesk sends supported webhook events using HTTPS POST. Failed webhook deliveries are retried up to 3 times. When troubleshooting send\_webhook, inspect the receiving endpoint and its response handling before changing unrelated automation criteria.

## **Automation Management Checklist**

- Use one clear purpose per rule.
- Choose only the supported trigger and actions required for the workflow.
- Keep matching criteria specific.
- Test with a small set of tickets before broad activation.
- Review active rules for overlapping conditions and actions.
- Confirm plan availability for related API or webhook capabilities.
- Deactivate rules that are no longer needed.
- Re-test automations after significant workflow changes.

## See also

Automation works with FlowDesk ticket management, customer management, API access, webhooks, and team workflows. Use the relevant product documentation for details about those capabilities and their plan requirements.